

Facilitator Kit • Principal Implementation Checklist

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

Trust your hackles. Pause • Check • Tell.

FIELD COPY

1  Lock It PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS	2  Spot It SCAMS AND FAKES	3  Share Smart PRIVACY
4  Safe People WHO TO TRUST	5  Kind and Well KINDNESS AND BALANCE	6  Fix It TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

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Hackles Facilitator Kit, Document 7 of 10. A practical, tick-the-box guide for a principal (or assistant principal, or any school leader) who wants to put Hackles in place well: policy, counselor, families, schedules, opt-outs and evaluation that collects no student data.

[Logo: Hackles]

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No student accounts, no student data collected, ever.

TO VERIFY

Consult counsel and policy. Reporting duties, parent notice, opt-out rights, curriculum review, photography and recording, and staff evaluation rules differ by state, district and school type. Every item marked [VERIFY] must be confirmed with your district office and counsel before you act on it. This checklist is educational guidance, not legal advice.

How to use this checklist

Try this now (10 minutes): tick, or write a date next to, the first three boxes in "Before the first lesson" below, and put a 30-minute meeting with your counselor on your calendar. If you do nothing else today, do that.

- **Print it. Tick it. Date it.** Make one copy for yourself and one for your counselor.
- It is organized by **when** to act (Section 1), then by **topic** (Sections 2 to 10).
- Every item is small enough to finish in a sitting. Most items have an owner column; write names in.
- You do not need to do everything before the first lesson. The "Before the first lesson" list at the top of Section 1 is the minimum.

01 The 12-week implementation timeline

BEFORE THE FIRST LESSON (THE MINIMUM LIST)

- ☐ The staff reporting route is written down, on a card, in every teacher's binder (H7 My School's Help Map). [VERIFY the route and the deadline with district counsel.]
- ☐ The school counselor knows the plan and has agreed to be available for sensitive lessons.
- ☐ Staff have had at least one training (the 90-Minute or Half-Day Workshop), including the disclosure practice.
- ☐ Families have been told what Hackles is, and have a way to ask questions and preview materials.
- ☐ The first lessons are scheduled (not squeezed in).
- ☐ There is a written plan for opt-outs, with a respectful alternative activity.
- ☐ The plan for evaluating the program uses **no student data**.

THE TIMELINE

WHEN	WHAT	OWNER	DONE
12 weeks before	Read the Teacher Primer, the Disclosure and Incident Guide and the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit. Ask your district: do we need curriculum approval or notice before teaching? [VERIFY]	Principal	[]
12 weeks before	Meet the counselor (30 minutes). Share this checklist. Choose a "Hackles lead" (a teacher, librarian or counselor) to coordinate.	Principal, counselor	[]
10 weeks before	Confirm the policy alignment items (Section 2). Schedule the family communication calendar.	Principal	[]
8 weeks before	Book the staff workshop (90-Minute or Half-Day) and the safety partner. Book Parent Night.	Principal, counselor	[]
6 weeks before	Send the first family notice (Section 6). Order printing. Fill in the Help Map (H7).	Hackles lead	[]
5 weeks before	Run the staff workshop. Collect exit tickets.	Principal, counselor	[]
4 weeks before	Publish the lesson schedule by grade (Section 5). Identify the first sensitive lesson date.	Hackles lead	[]
3 weeks before first sensitive lesson	Confirm counselor availability and policy on notice and opt-out.	Principal, counselor	[]
2 weeks before first sensitive lesson	Send the sensitive-lesson pre-notice to families.	Teachers	[]
1 week before	Offer family preview. Collect opt-out requests. Arrange alternatives. Parent Night (if scheduled).	Counselor, teachers	[]
First lesson	Visit one classroom. Thank the teacher.	Principal	[]
Weeks 1 to 20	Micro-PD at staff meetings (Sessions 1 to 10), one every other meeting (the recommended pace; weekly sessions finish in 10 weeks). Peer observation begins.	Hackles lead	[]
Week 6	Check in with teachers and counselor: what is working, what is stuck?	Principal	[]
After the last Micro-PD session	Celebrate (a Hackles Day or classroom showcase). Collect adult feedback. Review the data-free evaluation (Section 8).	All	[]
Every August	Refresh the Help Map, contact numbers, trained staff list and the family notices.	Hackles lead	[]

02 Policy alignment

HACKLES IS A CLASSROOM curriculum. It must fit inside your school's and district's existing rules. Walk through this list with your administrator or district office.

POLICIES TO CHECK

POLICY OR REQUIREMENT	THE QUESTION TO ASK	WHO TO ASK	DONE
Mandated reporting	What are our staff's personal duties and deadlines under state law? Does telling a principal or counselor satisfy the duty? Who is our designated contact? [VERIFY]	District counsel, HR	[]
Child-protection policy	Does our written policy match the Disclosure and Incident Guide (listen, reassure, do not investigate, report personally, document)? If not, which does staff follow? (Policy wins; align the two.)	Administrator	[]
Sensitive instruction notice and opt-out	Does our state or district require advance notice, preview or an opt-out for lessons on topics like body safety, exploitation, or relationships? [VERIFY]	District, counsel	[]
Curriculum adoption and review	Does a supplementary curriculum need board, committee or district approval? Are there materials review requirements? [VERIFY]	District office	[]
State internet-safety education requirements	Does our state require online-safety instruction or policies? What does ours say? [VERIFY]	District office	[]
Federal requirements on internet safety education (for example E-Rate and CIPA)	Does our district's internet-safety policy require education on appropriate online behavior? Does Hackles help us meet it? [CIPA requirement VERIFIED 2026-10-05: usac.org/e-rate/applicant-process/starting-services/cipa ; confirm your district's policy with your technology office]	District tech office	[]
Bullying and harassment policy	Do the Cyberbullying procedures in the Disclosure Guide match ours? Which staff report which incidents, and how fast? [VERIFY]	Administrator	[]
Acceptable use and device policy	Do students lose devices for telling us about problems? (They should not.)	Tech coordinator	[]
Safe-to-tell statement	Can we add a line to our policy: "A student who tells an adult about being tricked or targeted will not be disciplined for the act of telling, even if rules were broken in the process (for example being on an app under the age limit)"? [VERIFY with counsel for scope and wording]	Principal, counsel	[]
Photography, recording and visitors	Rules for classroom visitors, peer observers, volunteers and photos. [VERIFY]	Administrator	[]
Staff evaluation and peer coaching	Peer observation must be separate from evaluation. [VERIFY with contract and union]	HR, union	[]
AI and chatbot policy	Does our district have guidance on AI tools in classrooms? Hackles does not use any student-facing AI. [VERIFY]	District tech office	[]
Privacy and data	Hackles collects no student accounts or data. Confirm that no one adds a tool that does. [VERIFY with your district privacy officer]	Tech coordinator, privacy officer	[]
Language access	Process for translated family letters and interpreters. [VERIFY]	Family liaison	[]

POLICY ALIGNMENT: WHAT TO WRITE DOWN

Keep a one-page "Hackles Alignment Note" in your files, with the date and who confirmed each item. If a policy and the kit differ, **the policy wins**. Tell the Hackles lead so that teachers are never given conflicting instructions.

03 Counselor involvement

THE SCHOOL COUNSELOR (OR psychologist or social worker) is the most important partner you have. The counselor is **not** a bottleneck, and teachers must never wait for them before they report. But the counselor makes the program safer.

THE COUNSELOR'S ROLES (AGREE ON THESE)

- ☐ **Advisor on sensitive lessons.** Reviews lesson plans and the calendar. Agrees which lessons are sensitive in your building (see the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit, Section 1).
- ☐ **On call during sensitive lessons.** Available during and right after each one, with a backup.
- ☐ **Safety partner at staff training.** In the room or next door during the disclosure role-play.
- ☐ **First stop for staff support.** Debriefs a teacher after a disclosure (same day).
- ☐ **Small group host.** Offers small groups for students with shared concerns (being targeted online, supporting a friend).
- ☐ **Anonymous summary.** Gives the principal a short monthly tally with no names: lessons delivered, referrals, themes, needs.
- ☐ **Co-teacher option.** Can co-teach the last five minutes of a sensitive lesson.

MEETING AGENDA (30 MINUTES WITH THE COUNSELOR)

MIN	TOPIC
0-5	Why this program; what the kit contains (Teacher Primer)
5-12	The sensitive lesson list and timeline (Counselor Toolkit)
12-18	The reporting route and any gaps (Disclosure and Incident Guide, H7)
18-24	Counselor capacity: how many lessons per week can you be on call for? What do you need from me?
24-28	Teacher support after a disclosure (self-care)
28-30	Next steps

PROTECT THE COUNSELOR

- Do not add this to the counselor's workload without removing something. Offer coverage for lunch duty or paperwork.
- Plan a **backup** for when the counselor is absent (assistant principal, psychologist, social worker, district crisis team). [VERIFY]
- Schedule sensitive lessons to spread out across the week and the term. See Section 5.

04 Staff training and mentoring

ITEM	DETAIL	DONE
Initial training	Run the 90-Minute or Half-Day Workshop for all teachers who will teach Hackles, and for the counselor, librarian, tech coordinator and paraprofessionals.	[]
Micro-PD	Add one of the ten 15-minute sessions to staff meetings every other week.	[]
Mentors	Name one or two Hackles Mentors (see the Train-the-Trainer Guide). Give them a stipend or release time if you can. [VERIFY]	[]
Substitutes and new hires	Give every new teacher the Teacher Primer, H7 and the First 10 Minutes card (H6) on day one.	[]
Classified staff	Include bus drivers, cafeteria and office staff in a short session (Micro-PD 1, 3 and 4). They are trusted adults too.	[]
Annual refresher	Run a 90-minute refresh each August.	[]
Wellbeing	Remind staff of the EAP. Allow a teacher who is a survivor to ask a colleague to lead sensitive lessons. [VERIFY EAP]	[]

Your own training: attend the workshop as a participant at least once. Say the pledge. Practice "Thank you for telling me."

05 Schedules

WHERE DOES A 15-MINUTE LESSON FIT?

SLOT	WORKS WELL FOR	NOTES
Advisory or homeroom	6-12	A natural, protected block
Morning meeting or circle	K-5	Fits the hook-activity-takeaway shape
Library or media center	K-12	The librarian can co-teach
Technology or computer class	3-12	Good for passphrase and phish lessons
Health, counseling or SEL block	6-12	Good for sensitive lessons with counselor support
Specials rotation	K-5	Library or counselor can lead
Hackles Day (once a year)	All	See the Hackles Day Kit. It reinforces, it does not replace, weekly lessons.

PACING

- **Weekly, 10 weeks** (one 15-minute lesson per week) is the recommended pace. A longer or shorter pace is fine.
- **Start with non-sensitive lessons** (for example K-2 Lessons 2, 3, 4; 3-5 Lessons 2, 3; 6-8 Lessons 2, 3; 9-12 Lessons 1, 2, 3) to build teacher confidence.
- **Spread sensitive lessons out.** For grades 9-12, do not teach Lessons 5 and 7 on the same day, on a day with a major exam, on a Friday afternoon before a long weekend, or after a recent known incident in that class, without counselor input (as the 9-12 Teacher Guide advises).
- **Counselor availability first.** Put the sensitive lesson on the calendar only when you know the counselor is free.
- **Mid-morning is best.** Avoid the last period on a Friday.

SAMPLE 10-WEEK CALENDAR (ADAPT TO YOUR NEEDS)

WEEK	K-2	3-5	6-8	9-12
1	Lesson 1 My Tell-Someone Team	Lesson 1 Help Ladder (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 1 Help Ladder: Real Practice (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 1 Threat-Model Yourself
2	Lesson 2 Secret Passwords	Lesson 2 Passphrase Lab	Lesson 2 Account Defense	Lesson 2 Credentials and Passkeys
3	Lesson 3 Pause and Ask	Lesson 3 Scam Spotters	Lesson 3 Phish Lab	Lesson 3 Social Engineering Case Lab
4	Lesson 4 The Oops Button	Lesson 4 Secret Code Lab	Lesson 4 Footprint and Permissions	Lesson 4 Data Brokers and Location
5	Lesson 5 Private vs. Public	Lesson 5 Data Detective	Lesson 5 Chatbots and AI Companions	Lesson 5 (sensitive: counselor)
6	Lesson 6 (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 6 (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 6 (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 6 Synthetic Media and Truth
7	Lesson 7 Kind Clicks	Lesson 7 Upstander Moves	Lesson 7 (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 7 (sensitive: counselor)
8	Lesson 8 Real or Pretend?	Lesson 8 Real or Fake?	Lesson 8 (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 8 (sensitive: counselor)
9	Lesson 9 (sensitive: counselor)	Lesson 9 Family Code Word	Lesson 9 Group Chat Dynamics	Lesson 9 Ethics and Careers
10	Lesson 10 Screen Balance	Lesson 10 Oops Recovery	Lesson 10 Built to Keep You Scrolling	Lesson 10 Capstone

Note: in the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit, 3-5 Lesson 1 and 6-8 Lesson 1 count as sensitive because they rehearse telling about worries. Either send the pre-notice before Week 1, or begin those bands with Lesson 2 and move Lesson 1 later. The sensitive lessons are those listed in the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out

Toolkit. Lesson numbers follow each band's Teacher Guide; confirm against your copy.

06 **Parent and family notice**

FAMILIES ARE PARTNERS. TRANSPARENCY builds trust and prevents surprises.

WHAT FAMILIES SHOULD HEAR, AND WHEN

WHEN	WHAT	WHERE TO FIND IT
6 weeks before	Program overview: what Hackles is, that it is skills-based and non-graphic, that no student accounts or data are collected, and how to preview materials	Family Engagement Pack
At the start	Invitation to Parent Night and preview time	Parent Night Presentation Script
2 weeks before each sensitive lesson	Sensitive-lesson pre-notice with opt-out and review options [Confirm notice requirements with district counsel]	Family Engagement Pack; Counselor Toolkit
1 week before	Reminder and invitation to preview	Teacher
After each lesson	Family card and conversation starter go home	Teacher Guides (Family card)
End of term	Thank-you, a short family feedback slip	Family Engagement Pack

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Letters are translation-ready and reviewed by a qualified translator or language-access team (not unreviewed machine translation). [VERIFY policy]
- ☐ There is a phone number or email for questions: [CONTACT: to be added].
- ☐ The letter says "No student accounts, no student data collected, ever."
- ☐ The letter names the counselor and says how to reach them.
- ☐ Parent Night is scheduled with childcare, interpreters and a warm, no-fear script (see Parent_Night_Presentation_Script).
- ☐ A preview is offered in person, by phone and on paper.
- ☐ The Family Code Word and Family Tech Agreement are offered as optional tools.
- ☐ Families are never told "your child is unsafe" or "you are failing."

tone rules for family communication

- Warm, hopeful, practical.
- No scary statistics, no stories about real children, no blame.
- "We are partners. You know your child best."
- "If you would like to opt out of a lesson, we will respect that."

07 Supporting sensitive-lesson opt-outs

RESPECTING A FAMILY'S WISHES protects trust and the child. Handle every request with warmth and confidentiality. The full process is in the Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit, Section 6. This is what the principal owns.

PRINCIPLES

- ☐ **Never penalize** the student, academically or socially.
- ☐ **Never ask a child** to explain a family's decision.
- ☐ **Offer the review first.** Many opt-outs become participation after a family sees the materials.
- ☐ **The core help message still reaches the child**, in family-approved language: "If anything ever worries you, tell a grown-up you trust. You are never in trouble."
- ☐ **Confirm local rules.** In some places opt-out is required, optional or not allowed. [VERIFY]
- ☐ **Do not use the words "left out."** Do not suggest a family is putting a child at risk.
- ☐ **Keep records confidential**, per policy.

PRACTICAL STEPS

STEP	WHO	DONE
Decide where opted-out students go during a sensitive lesson (library, counselor-led small group, a quiet reading activity or a general kindness or screen-balance activity from the same strand)	Principal, counselor	[]
Make sure the alternative is supervised by a trusted adult and is not stigmatizing (no "you're in the hall" feeling)	Principal	[]
Arrange coverage so the teacher is not pulled away	Principal	[]
Offer the family the take-home card and conversation starters	Teacher	[]
Offer the counselor session option	Counselor	[]
Confirm that no staff member comments on a child's opt-out to the child or other students	Principal	[]
Let families change their mind at any time	Teacher	[]
Review the process each year	Principal	[]

WHAT TO SAY TO A CONCERNED FAMILY (USE A CALM TONE)

- "I can hear you care a lot about your child. Thank you for contacting me."
- "Would you like to see the lesson? I can walk you through it."
- "It uses no graphic content. It focuses on telling a trusted adult."

- "If you prefer to opt out, we will respect that and offer an alternative. We will make sure your child knows who to tell if something ever worries them."

What not to say: "Your child will be left out." "You are keeping them unsafe." "Everyone else is doing it."

08 Data-free evaluation

Hackles collects **no student accounts and no student data, ever**. You can still tell whether the program is working, by looking at **adult implementation, adult confidence, classroom-level themes and counselor tallies without names**.

WHAT TO TRACK (AND WHERE IT COMES FROM)

QUESTION	MEASURE	SOURCE	STUDENT DATA?
Are lessons being taught?	Count of lessons taught per grade per month	Teacher check-in (a simple tally)	No
Are teachers prepared?	Teacher confidence rating (1 to 5) on the exit ticket, at the start and after 10 weeks	H15 anonymous exit ticket; adult survey (see Facilitator Evaluation and Certificates)	No
Are lessons fun, safe, skill-based?	Themes from peer observation	H13 (kept by the teacher; share only anonymous themes)	No
Do staff know the reporting route?	Percentage of staff who can name their reporting contact	A one-question staff poll	No
Are families informed and comfortable?	Number of notices sent, previews offered, opt-outs requested (counts only), family feedback slips (anonymous)	Family Engagement Pack	No
Are children telling?	The counselor's anonymous count of referrals and conversations that followed lessons, with themes	Counselor summary, no names	No (counts only, no identifiers)
What are classes learning?	Themes from anonymous exit tickets sorted by the teacher, with names covered	Teacher, PLC 5	No identifiers

A NOTE ABOUT DISCLOSURES AS A MEASURE

More children telling is a **sign of success**, not of failure. Do not use a rise in referrals as a mark against a teacher, a grade or the school. Explain this to your board and your community. [VERIFY any reporting your district requires.]

WHAT NOT TO DO

- **Do not** collect student names, scores, accounts or device information.
- **Do not** track individual students' progress, test results or responses.
- **Do not** record students on video or audio. [VERIFY policy]

- **Do not** ask students to share personal experiences for "evidence."
- **Do not** add a software tool or a platform that collects student data.
- **Do not** compare teachers by their disclosure counts.
- **Do not** use student quotes in reports that could identify a child.

THE ONE-PAGE ANNUAL REPORT (A TEMPLATE)

FIELD	ENTRY
Teachers trained	
Lessons taught (by grade)	
Average teacher confidence at start and at 10 weeks	
Peer observation cycles completed	
Sensitive lessons taught with counselor on call	
Family notices sent, previews held, opt-outs honored (counts)	
Counselor referrals after lessons (anonymous count)	
Stories of success (no names, no identifying details)	
What we will change next year	

09 Disclosure readiness (principal's checklist)

WHEN HACKLES WORKS, CHILDREN tell. Your school has to be ready.

- ☐ **Everyone knows the route.** Every teacher has H7. Ask a few teachers, kindly and not as a test: "Who do you call first?" If anyone hesitates, fix the card, not the person.
- ☐ **The First 10 Minutes card (H6) is in every classroom binder.**
- ☐ **Staff know their personal duty.** Telling the principal does not by itself satisfy a teacher's duty to report in many places. Never say "tell me and I'll handle it" in a way that stops staff from reporting. [VERIFY]
- ☐ **You, as principal, know your own duties.** [VERIFY]
- ☐ **Coverage plan:** if a teacher needs to meet a child, a colleague covers the class.
- ☐ **Private, visible meeting spaces** are identified (door open or windows).
- ☐ **Device handling policy:** staff know not to look at, copy, forward or screenshot images, and who secures a device. [VERIFY]
- ☐ **Documentation:** the Disclosure and Incident Record template is available, with secure storage.
- ☐ **Crisis plan** for a child at risk of self-harm: who, where, how, and 988. [VERIFIED 2026-10-05: 988lifeline.org]
- ☐ **Staff support:** teachers know the debrief route and the EAP. [VERIFY]
- ☐ **No retaliation:** a teacher who reports in good faith will be supported.
- ☐ **No blame in the building:** staff understand "never your fault" applies to adults too.

10 Budget and supplies

HACKLES IS FREE. THESE are typical costs, mostly time.

ITEM	TYPICAL COST	NOTES
Printing (handouts, cards, posters)	Low	Print in black and white on colored paper
Station and game supplies	Low	Sticky notes, index cards, tape, markers
Snacks for workshops	Low to medium	Check allergy rules [VERIFY]
Prizes (stickers, a pickle trophy)	Very low	Optional
Substitute coverage for peer observation	Medium	Use planning periods, a counselor, librarian or an administrator for coverage
Mentor stipend or release time	Varies	Optional [VERIFY]
Parent Night (childcare, interpreters, snacks)	Medium	Seek PTA or community partners [VERIFY]
Certificates	Very low	Printable (see Facilitator Evaluation and Certificates)

11 Ready-to-use communications

STAFF ANNOUNCEMENT (EMAIL)

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
Subject: Hackles: free online-safety lessons, starting [date] Colleagues, we are launching Hackles, a free 15-minute-lesson program that teaches students to notice when something online feels off and to Pause, Check and Tell. It uses paper and pencil, collects no student data, and comes with word-for-word scripts. We will begin with a [90-minute or 3-hour] workshop on [date]. You will not have to be a tech expert, you will not be asked to share any personal stories, and you will have fun. [Counselor name] is partnering with us for every sensitive lesson. Thank you. [Name]	

FAMILY NEWSLETTER BLURB

FIELD NOTE	No. 2
Hackles: helping our kids trust their gut online. This term, students will learn a simple routine: Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell. The lessons are short, practical and not scary. We do not collect any student accounts or data. You are welcome to preview any lesson, and we will tell you in advance about any lesson on a sensitive topic. Please contact [CONTACT: to be added] with questions. Learn more at competencecollective.org.	

WHEN SOMEONE ASKS "IS THIS AGE-APPROPRIATE?"

FIELD NOTE	No. 3
"Great question. The lessons are age-banded. For the youngest, the focus is: pause, ask a grown-up, and tell. For older students, we use fictional cases and practice what to say and who to tell. Nothing is graphic, and nobody is asked to share a personal story. We are glad to walk you through the materials."	

WHEN SOMEONE SAYS "WON'T THIS GIVE KIDS IDEAS?"

TO VERIFY "The lessons teach recognition and response, not how to commit harm. They give children words to say no and to tell. Research on prevention suggests skills-based teaching, not fear, is more effective [VERIFY Finkelhor et al., 2021]."	
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12 Risk check

RISK	WHAT COULD GO WRONG	PREVENTION
Teacher uses scare tactics	Students are frightened; families upset	The Facilitator Guide, rubric and peer coaching; Safety Slip script
Sensitive lesson without notice	Families surprised; trust lost	Timeline in Section 1; counselor heads-up
Counselor overload	Disclosures not supported	Spread lessons; backup plan
A disclosure is mishandled	A child is harmed	H6, H7, the Disclosure and Incident Guide; role-play practice
Opt-out stigma	A child feels singled out	Section 7
Policy conflict	Staff confused	Alignment Note (Section 2)
Data creep	A tool collects student data	"No student data" rule; privacy officer review
Staff turnover	The program fades	Mentors; annual refresher

13 Sign-off

ITEM	PRINCIPAL INITIALS	DATE
Policy alignment note on file		
Counselor agreement on file		
Staff trained		
Family notices sent		
Opt-out plan ready		
Disclosure readiness checked		
Evaluation plan data-free		

This checklist is educational guidance, not legal advice. Consult your administrator, district policy and counsel. [VERIFY]